

PhoneShake Vending

\$6k a month from one machine you run entirely from your phone, from anywhere on earth.

What It Is

A fully automated protein-shake vending business. You place self-serve machines in gyms and fitness spaces; customers pick a shake, pay, and the machine blends a fresh drink in seconds — no employees, no café, no waiting. A connected app lets you track sales, monitor inventory, and watch real-time performance from anywhere, so the whole business runs from your phone.

How It Makes Money

High-margin sales on every shake, 24/7, with near-zero labor. Because margins are strong, even a few dozen customers a day generates thousands monthly. You scale by reinvesting profit into more machines in additional gyms — a hands-off, location-stacking model. Add supplement upsells and sponsored flavors for extra revenue.

Startup Costs

- Protein-shake vending machine with app/telemetry (Alibaba: "smart protein shake vending machine app"): \$4,000–\$10,000 per unit
- Shipping + import duty: \$400–\$1,200
- Initial ingredient stock (protein, base, fruit, cups): \$400–\$700
- Card reader / connectivity (often built in): \$0–\$300
- LLC, insurance, food-handling permit: \$500–\$1,500
- Gym placement deposit or first month rev-share: \$0–\$500
- Branding/wrap + signage: \$300–\$600
- **Total to launch (first machine): \$5,500–\$13,000**

The Numbers

- Cost per shake: \$1.20–\$2.00
- Sell price: \$6–\$8
- Profit per shake: \$4.50–\$6.50
- A solid gym machine serves 35–60 shakes/day
- 45 shakes/day x \$5 profit x 30 = **~\$6,750/month profit per machine**
- After a small gym rev-share, ~\$6,000 net. Stack 4–5 machines across gyms = **\$25,000–\$33,000/month**, all managed from the app.

How To Start

1. Order one app-connected machine from a vetted supplier; confirm real-time telemetry, card payments, and warranty/parts.
2. Form an LLC and get a basic food-handling permit.
3. Pitch a busy gym a flat rent or revenue-share for floor space — it's a free amenity for them.
4. Dial in 4–6 popular flavors and source ingredients from a bulk wholesaler.

5. Install, brand the machine, and configure pricing and the management app.
6. Run it remotely: monitor sales, get low-stock alerts, restock 2–3x/week.
7. Once profitable, reinvest into machines 2–5 in similar gyms and manage the fleet from one app.

Where To Get Customers

Placement is the customer — target high-traffic gyms, CrossFit boxes, university rec centers, martial-arts academies, and sports complexes. Negotiate directly with gym owners and managers; lead with a rev-share so the space is an easy yes.

Pro Tips

- Use the app data ruthlessly — kill dead flavors, restock before stockouts, and relocate any underperforming machine fast instead of letting it bleed.
- A rev-share beats free placement requests; paying the gym a cut wins prime floor space and keeps the owner invested in your uptime.
- Standardize on one machine model and one ingredient supplier so a 5-machine fleet stays simple to restock, service, and manage remotely.